

# THE BOYLET CLUB

**They make news for their hair, their girls, their buddies and even their mommies. How do you recognise the alpha boys of Bollywood? Try this.**

■ By Kaverie Bamzai

**T**hey have hair issues, weight problems, take off their clothes when they are told to and are never far from the scandal sheets. They obsess about what to wear to parties and sport trophy girlfriends when they attend such gatherings. They don't party too much, go to temples, have sugar daddies, and

almost always return home to their mammas. Meet the boylets, the male starlets, who fight for publicists, bitch about other boys, stage fights to catch attention, and are increasingly famous for being familiar. In a culture where the men are usually the lookers and the women looked at, they are rewriting the rules of the attention game. Boys may sell the movies (at least the older boys do) but it's the boys'

Illustrations by SAURABH SHYAM



starlet-like behaviour which teases the tabloids. So what is a boy to do but become a boylet? And, how does one recognise a boylet? Try these 10 foolproof ways:

**1. Find a trophy girlfriend** Boylets by themselves are not news, but when alpha boys meet beta females, they get attention of the flashbulb kind. Ask serial dater Upen Patel, who seems to have slowly worked his way up the Bollywood ladder, starting by being Amrita Arora's boyfriend and was recently heard denying rumours of being Deepika Padukone's ex. In classic Hollywood, studios would set up love lives to ensure their stars remained in the imagination of the paying public. Bollywood boylets now do their own social engineering.

Following in the time-honoured tradition of John Abraham (who benefited by dating Bipasha Basu post-*Jism*) and Shahid Kapur (who went from being just another bright young possibility to seeing Bollywood princess Kareena Kapoor), Harman Baweja has also become a permanent gossip fixture by being "good friends" with Priyanka Chopra even before his first film, *Love Story 2050*, is out. It doesn't hurt that daddy, the action film expert Harry Baweja, is directing the film.

**2. Always mention mommy** Time was when every starlet worth her weight in beehive hairdos and costume jewellery would be accompanied by mummyji. Nowadays the young starlets are of a different, more independent breed. Padukone's mother is busy preparing for younger sister Anisha's golfing career, Sonam Kapoor's mother Sunita has always had her hands full with her jewellery business and gyms, and Kangana Ranaut is seen more often with daddyji-type good friend Aditya Panscholi. But the boys, now they're different. Their mothers accompany them to some television interviews (Ranbir and Neetu Kapoor) and usually vet their scripts (Neil Nitin Mukesh). Such boylets like to emphasise their good boy credentials. Ranbir belongs to the Kapoor clan which is well known for its excesses. But he seems to be content to sip his chocolate milkshake, let his mother control